KEN DALA

THE KEN DALA COLLECTION / 2026

TÜRKIYE

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

A considered guide to the places, flavours and practical details that make a journey unforgettable.

THE COMPLETE TRAVELLER'S COMPANION

Prepared for travellers from Kazakhstan

START HERE

Your journey, curated.

Everything worth knowing before you go — designed to be saved, shared and taken along.

01 **The essentials**
Currency, language, time and entry

02 **When to visit**
Seasons, weather and what to pack

03 **Places to remember**
From Istanbul to the turquoise coast

04 **Move beautifully**
Airports, city transport and intercity travel

05 **Live like a local**
Culture, dining, payments and useful apps

06 **Travel confidently**
Safety, checklists and essential links

01 / THE ESSENTIALS

Know before you go

A few practical details will make your arrival in Türkiye smoother.

Currency

Turkish lira (TRY / ₺). Cards are common in cities; keep some lira for markets, tips and smaller towns.

Language

Turkish is the official language. English is common in major hotels and tourist districts, less so elsewhere.

Time zone

Türkiye uses UTC+3 year-round. Kazakhstan uses UTC+5, so Türkiye is 2 hours behind.

Electricity

230V, 50Hz. Type C and F plugs. Pack an adapter if your devices use a different plug.

PASSPORT & ENTRY

Kazakhstani citizens generally have visa-free access for short tourist stays (commonly up to 90 days within 180 days). Confirm the latest rules, passport validity and any special conditions with official Turkish authorities before booking.

02 / TIMING

Find your season.

The ideal month depends on whether you dream of city streets, warm beaches or mountain landscapes.

SPRING

MAR – MAY • 12–23°C

Blooming parks, Istanbul walks, Cappadocia and fewer peak-season crowds.

SUMMER

JUN – AUG • 25–35°C+

Beach weather on the Aegean and Mediterranean; hot and busy inland.

AUTUMN

SEP – NOV • 13–28°C

Warm seas early in the season, city breaks and excellent sightseeing.

WINTER

DEC – FEB • 0–15°C

Ski resorts and quieter cities; snow and freezing temperatures inland.

Temperature ranges are broad regional guides, not forecasts.

03 / DESTINATIONS

Places worth the journey.

Build an itinerary around a feeling, not simply a checklist.

01

ISTANBUL

Where empires meet

Hagia Sophia, the Bosphorus, bazaars, neighbourhood cafés and ferries. Allow 3–5 days.

02

CAPPADOCIA

Otherworldly horizons

Fairy chimneys, cave stays and sunrise balloon views. Allow 2–3 days; flights are weather-dependent.

03

ANTALYA

The Mediterranean edit

Old Town lanes, waterfalls, resorts, ancient sites and long beach days. Allow 3–5 days.

03 / DESTINATIONS

Beyond the icons.

Build an itinerary around a feeling, not simply a checklist.

04

BODRUM

Aegean sophistication

Boutique stays, marinas, coves and a relaxed coastal rhythm.

05

FETHIYE & ÖLÜDENIZ

The turquoise escape

Blue Lagoon, boat days, hiking trails and dramatic coastline.

06

PAMUKKALE & EPHESUS

History in the landscape

Travertine terraces, Hierapolis and the remarkable ancient city of Ephesus.

04 / ARRIVALS

Arrive with ease.

Major international gateways and the simplest ways to get started.

IST	**Istanbul Airport** Major international hub on Istanbul's European side.
SAW	**Sabiha Gökçen** Istanbul airport on the Asian side; check which airport your ticket uses.
AYT	**Antalya Airport** Main gateway for Antalya and many Mediterranean resorts.
ADB	**Izmir Adnan Menderes** Useful for Izmir, Ephesus and the Aegean region.
BJV / DLM	**Bodrum / Dalaman** Popular gateways for Bodrum, Fethiye and coastal holidays.
ASR / NAV	**Kayseri / Nevşehir** Two common gateways for Cappadocia; transfer times differ.

From Kazakhstan: Check current nonstop or connecting routes from Almaty and Astana; airlines and seasonal schedules change.

05 / MOBILITY

The art of getting around.

Pick the right mode for each part of your trip.

In the city

Istanbul has metro, tram, ferries and buses; an Istanbulkart is useful. Other cities have their own transit cards.

Between cities

Domestic flights save time on long routes. High-speed trains serve selected corridors; intercity coaches cover many others.

Airport transfers

Compare official airport buses, rail links where available, licensed taxis and pre-booked transfers.

Taxis & driving

Use licensed taxis and reputable apps where available. Confirm the meter or fare; check tolls, parking and insurance on rentals.

06 / SPENDING

Money, made simple.

Pay confidently without losing track of the small details.

Cards & cash

Visa and Mastercard are widely accepted in major tourist areas. Carry small notes for taxis, bazaars and rural stops.

ATMs & banks

ATMs are widely available. Common banks include Ziraat Bankası, İşbank, Garanti BBVA, Akbank and Yapı Kredi.

Exchange wisely

Compare rates and fees. When a terminal offers a choice, paying in TRY often avoids poor dynamic-conversion rates.

Budget planning

Costs vary sharply by destination and season. Budget separately for hotels, meals, local transport, attractions and tips.

A SMART TRAVEL HABIT

Notify your bank before departure if needed, carry a backup card and avoid relying on one payment method. Check the live KZT/TRY rate before travel.

07 / LOCAL LIFE

The culture of welcome.

Small gestures make a big difference.

Respectful visits

Dress modestly when entering mosques; women may need a head covering. Remove shoes where requested and respect prayer times.

A few Turkish words

Merhaba = hello • Teşekkürler = thank you • Lütfen = please • Evet / Hayır = yes / no.

Food worth travelling for

Try a traditional breakfast, kebabs, meze, gözleme, baklava and Turkish tea or coffee. Ask about allergens and dietary needs.

Markets & etiquette

Bargaining may be expected in some bazaars, not in fixed-price stores. Ask before photographing people.

08 / TOOLKIT

Your pocket concierge.

Download key apps and offline information before you leave.

NAVIGATION

Google Maps • Apple Maps

Download offline maps; confirm ferry and transit information locally.

LANGUAGE

Google Translate

Download Turkish for offline translations.

TRANSPORT

BiTaksi • Uber • local transit apps

Coverage and services vary by city; verify availability.

AIR TRAVEL

Turkish Airlines • Pegasus

Manage check-in, baggage and flight notifications.

STAYS & EXPERIENCES

Your booking provider's app

Keep confirmations, addresses and contact details accessible offline.

CONNECTIVITY

Carrier app • eSIM provider

Check roaming or eSIM compatibility and current Turkish access restrictions.

09 / ESSENTIALS

Travel with confidence.

A few habits keep your attention on the experience, not the logistics.

1

Emergency

Dial 112 for emergency assistance in Türkiye.

2

Documents

Keep your passport, travel insurance, booking details and digital backups accessible.

3

Weather & conditions

Check official weather forecasts and local advisories, especially for balloons, mountain roads and boat trips.

4

Health

Bring required medication in original packaging and check rules for restricted medicines.

5

Connectivity

Verify your phone is unlocked and check roaming, SIM registration and eSIM rules.

6

Respect & awareness

Use licensed operators, watch your belongings in crowded areas and follow official local guidance.

10 / DEPARTURE

The final checklist.

A beautifully simple way to leave nothing important behind.

- [ ] Passport and current entry requirements checked
- [ ] Flights, hotel addresses and airport transfers saved
- [ ] Travel insurance and emergency contacts stored
- [ ] Bank cards, some Turkish lira and backup funds ready
- [ ] Offline maps, translation tools and booking apps installed
- [ ] Season-appropriate clothing and comfortable walking shoes
- [ ] Power adapter, charger and medication packed
- [ ] Weather, transport and attraction opening hours rechecked

For a smoother trip: Keep copies of important documents offline and share your itinerary with someone you trust.

11 / INSPIRATION

Make it your own.

Three ways to experience Türkiye, depending on your travel style.

5 DAYS

The Istanbul escape

Istanbul • Bosphorus • neighbourhoods

A focused city break with culture, cafés, markets and an unhurried ferry ride.

8 DAYS

Icons & landscapes

Istanbul • Cappadocia

Pair historic city discoveries with a magical inland landscape.

10 DAYS

Coast & culture

Istanbul • Ephesus • Bodrum / Antalya

Blend history with beach days, seaside dining and time to unwind.

12 / TRUSTED SOURCES

Useful links, always.

Policies, fares and opening hours change. Use official sources for final checks.

ENTRY & VISAS

evisa.gov.tr • mfa.gov.tr

TOURISM & DESTINATIONS

goturkiye.com

AIRPORTS

istairport.com • sabihagokcen.aero

RAIL TRAVEL

tcddtasimacilik.gov.tr

WEATHER

mgm.gov.tr

EMERGENCIES

112 — national emergency number

Editorial note: This guide is general travel information, not an entry guarantee or live fare quotation. Check official requirements for your nationality, itinerary and travel dates.

KEN DALA

THE WORLD IS YOURS TO DISCOVER.

Extraordinary journeys begin with curiosity — and the freedom to travel well.

KEN DALA / CURATED TRAVEL EXPERIENCES